

How do I know if I'm eating enough?



A step-by-step guide

Under fueling is extremely common among swim athletes. This is especially true for club swimmers who are growing rapidly. For common signs of under fueling, check out ABC's of nutrition. We recommend every swim athlete (with the exception of anyone who has struggled with eating disorder / disordered eating) complete 3 days of meal logging and compare it with our estimated starting calorie range.

Below is a step-by-step guide on how to best execute this on your own. If you're a younger athlete, you can execute this with the help of a parent/guardian! If you need additional help and/or want a more accurate estimate of energy intake and nutrient status, reach out to Coach Brittany at swimstrongdrylandnutrition@gmail.com.

STEP 1: DOWNLOAD THE FREE MYFITNESS PAL APP



STEP 2: SET UP A FREE ACCOUNT

Hear us out when we say – You can completely ignore any recommendations that the app provides. These will not apply to you as an endurance athlete! The app is set up for the general population. The app will ask you to input a calorie and macro goal. For your starting

calorie goal, refer to the chart below. This is a STARTING point. You may actually need MORE than listed (and in rare cases, less). For macros, you can use 50% carbohydrate, 25% protein and 25% fat. This is not prescriptive, just a starting point so you have something to input!

General Calorie Guidelines for Swim Athletes (Based on a Typical 2-3 hour practice)

Girls	Guys
▶ 10-11 y/o ▶ 2,300-2,800 calories	▶ 10-11 y/o ▶ 2,700-3,200 calories
▶ 12-13 y/o ▶ 2,520-3,020 calories	▶ 12-13 y/o ▶ 2,900-3,400 calories
▶ 14-18 y/o ▶ 2,700-3200 calories	▶ 14-15 y/o ▶ 3,100-3,800 calories
	▶ 16-18 y/o ▶ 3,500-4,000 calories

*Calorie needs are highly individual. Talk to your SSDL Nutrition Coach for more info!



Eat Enough

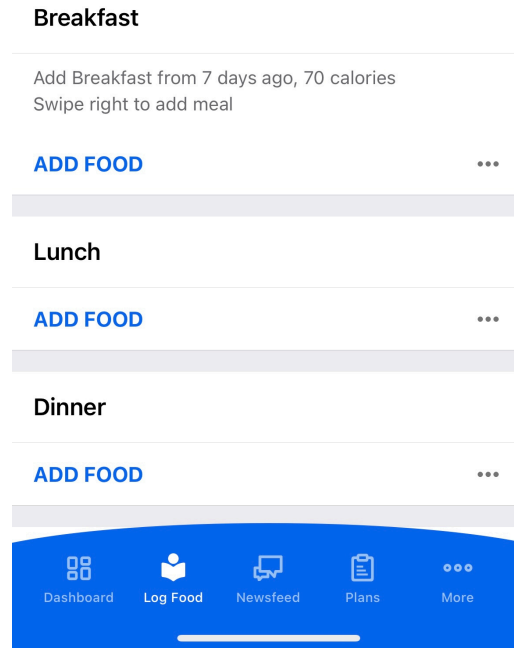
	Min. 0.7g+/lb/day
	2.7-4.5g/lb/day (more when training load increases)
	20-35% of diet

*Macronutrient needs are highly individual. Talk to your SSDL Nutrition Coach for more info!



STEP 3: LOG FOOD + BEVERAGES FOR 3 DAYS

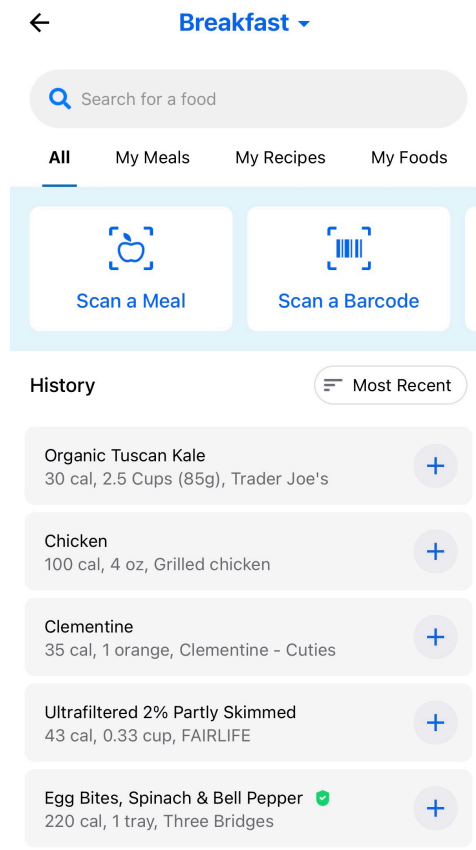
With the app open, go to the “Log Food” at the bottom of the screen. You will see Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner, Snacks, Exercise and Water. You will NOT need to record any exercise. You can either log directly into the app as you go about your day, or you can write everything down (for example, in a note in your phone) and then log it at the end of the day.



You do NOT need to weigh or measure your food, unless you have the time and want to. However, you WILL need to pay attention to serving sizes and/or you'll need to eyeball amounts (for example, know what $\frac{1}{2}$ cup looks like on a plate or in a bowl).

Simply go to the meal you want to log and click "ADD FOOD." Scanning a meal or barcode are "Premium" features that cannot be accessed in the free account. If you'd like to access these features, you would need to pay to upgrade to a "Premium" account. These features are convenient but not necessary to log for a few days! The app will also save a "History" of foods that you log, in case you have any repeat items over the course of 3 days.

Once you click "ADD FOOD" you will be able to search for a food at the top (next to the magnifying glass icon). If you know the brand, be sure to include this in your search for the most accurate results!



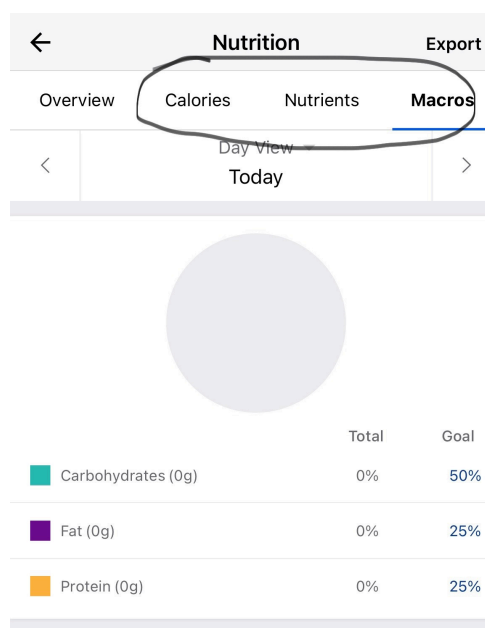
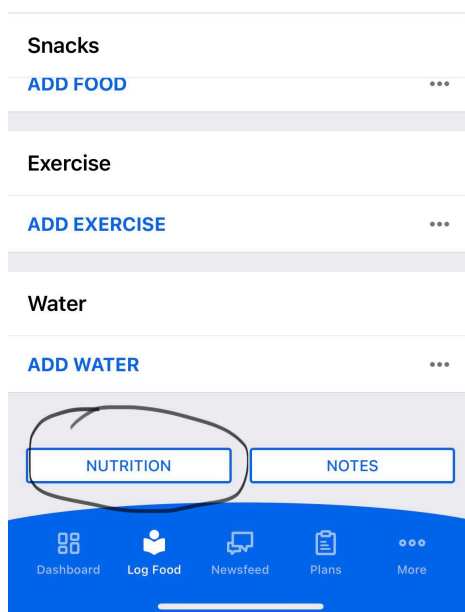
When your food item pops up, you'll notice a serving size listed. You will type in the number of servings you consumed (remember, serving sizes are for the general population and NOT for athletes!). You will then press the "check mark" at the top right of the screen and your food will be logged for that meal. Woohoo!!

Macronutrient	Percentage	Amount
Carbs	11%	6 g
Fat	63%	16 g
Protein	26%	15 g

STEP 4: REVIEW DAILY SUMMARIES

Once you are all finished logging for each day you will check your daily summary by clicking the "Nutrition" button in the "Log Food" tab. You will be given a brief overview, total calories consumed by meal (you can ignore net calories, as we aren't tracking your energy output

here), and a small list of specific nutrients and macros. Keep in mind, the list of nutrients does NOT cover everything, but it's a decent starting point.



Here's a quick breakdown of the questions you should ask yourself while reviewing your daily summaries:

1. Do my total calories closely align with my estimated calories needs?
2. Were my calories pretty evenly spread throughout the day?
3. What were my hunger and fullness levels like throughout the day?
4. Do my total macros closely align with my estimated needs?
5. Did my bigger meals contain all 3 macros in the right proportions?
6. Did my recovery snacks contain protein and carbohydrates?
7. Were there any nutrients that were super low (i.e. iron, calcium, vitamin c, etc.)? If yes, what food(s) can I add to my fueling plan to help fill in the gaps?

After reviewing your 3-day summaries, take note of your strengths and opportunities for growth. We recommend making necessary adjustments one small thing at a time and re-evaluating every 2-4 weeks. Rather than continuing to log meals to track progress, which is time intensive and tedious, we recommend filling out the SSDL Wellness Questionnaire which takes 1 minute or less. Now you are ready to get fueled up so you can CRUSH your goals and your competition.